



W H A L E C L A S S

# Circle Time Guide

## **BANG! From Dark to Stars**

Big Bang and the Universe · Week of May 6–7

*Everything you need, one page per day*

# Week Overview

🖨️ Print · laminate · ring-bind · hold this all week.

⚠️ **2-day week (Labour Day):** this week runs **Thursday 6 and Friday 7 May** only. Teach **Day 1** on Thursday and **Day 5** on Friday; Days 2–4 are optional — fold in whatever you have time for, or skip them.

## Five words they'll own by Friday

dark

light

star

big

bang

### Littles (2.5–3)

One word + a gesture is a win: **“Dark!”** (hands over eyes), **“BANG!”** (clap + jump), **“Star!”** (twinkle fingers).

### Bigs (4–6)

Sentence frames: **“It is dark.”** · **“I see a star.”** · **“The universe is very big.”** · **“I can \_\_\_\_!”**

## The 13 minutes, same every day

**2 min** Magic Box hook · **4 min** Teach · **3 min** Song · **3 min** Game · **1 min** Close

## What's in the box

**Mon** Nothing. An empty box under a black cloth — and the lights go off.

**Tue** A torch — the first light.

**Wed** A balloon — small, big, bigger... BANG!

**Thu** Glow-in-the-dark stars (lights off again).

**Fri** All the week's props + black paper and white chalk.

## Every day, without fail

“One, two, three — eyes on me!” · the Magic Box chant · Littles get one word + gesture, Bigs get the sentence frame · get something wrong on purpose once so they can correct you · close whisper → normal → shout.

**Dark Phonics this week:** short i — big, pig, dig, did, sit, it. **“big pig did a jig!”**

## MONDAY

# Dark! Nothing At All

Today's words: **dark**

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**Grab:** the Magic Box with **nothing** in it and a black cloth draped over it; a second black cloth big enough to go over your own head; the light switch (know where it is) or the curtains.

### 2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

The box today wears a black cloth. Shake it — silence. Hold it to your ear. Whole class chants:

EVERYONE “What’s in the box? What’s in the box?”

Peek in. Gasp. Peek again. Turn it upside down and shake. Nothing falls out.

TEACHER “Nothing! Nothing at all!” (*tip it towards them so they can all see the empty inside*) “Look inside — it is DARK.”

Everyone puts their hands over their eyes. **“Dark!”**

### 4 MIN TEACH · DARK

Lights OFF, curtains closed, everyone very still. Whisper the whole first part.

It is **dark**. (*hands over eyes*)  
No sun. (*shake head*)  
No moon. (*shake head*)  
No stars. (*shake head*)  
Nothing at all... (*open hands, empty*)

Say it three times, quieter each time. Then the black cloth goes over **your** head: “Where’s teacher? It’s DARK!” — off it comes, they shriek. Do it twice more, then let two children have a turn under the cloth.

Littles say the one word **“Dark!”** with hands over eyes — that is a full win at 2 and 3. Bigs say the frame: **“It is dark.”**

**Teacher fails:** put the black cloth over your **foot** and announce “Now I am hiding!” while your whole face is showing. Wait. Let them fix you twice — the correction shout is the loudest English of the day.

### 3 MIN SONG · THE BIG BANG BOOM — CHORUS + MONDAY VERSE

Dark! Dark! Everywhere dark! (*hands over eyes*)  
Then — a big, big, BIG BANG! (*clap and JUMP on BANG*)  
Stars! Stars! Look at the stars! (*twinkle fingers up high*)  
The universe goes BANG! (*one huge clap*)  
**Monday’s verse:** It was dark, dark, dark — no light at all, (*hands over eyes, sway*)  
No sun, no moon, no bouncy ball! (*shake head three times, then bounce an imaginary ball*)

**The one song of the week** — same chorus at every circle, one new verse each morning. Chords and the full sheet are on the Song tab. Sing it twice; the second time they will already jump on BANG.

### 3 MIN GAME · LIGHTS OFF, LIGHTS ON

“One, two, three — eyes on me!” You stand at the switch.

TEACHER “Lights... OFF!” (*flick, room goes dim*)

Everyone claps hands over their eyes and whispers **“Dark!”** — Bigs whisper **“It is dark.”**

TEACHER “Lights... ON!” (*flick*)

Everyone throws their hands wide and shouts **“LIGHT!”**

Six rounds, faster and faster, then one very long dark one where you all sit in the dark and count to five together. Last round: a Big gets to be the switch-caller.

*No dimmable room? A cardboard box over a torch does the same job on the carpet, or just everyone’s hands over their own eyes on your call.*

### 1 MIN CLOSE

Sitting, hands over eyes, whisper → normal → shout:

EVERYONE “Dark... dark... DARK!” (*hands fly off the eyes on the shout*)

**Got 3 spare minutes?** *The Dark* (Lemony Snicket & Jon Klassen) — don’t read every word, just turn the pages and whisper “dark... dark... dark” with them.

## TUESDAY

# Then... Light!

Today's words: **light** (*dark comes back every day*)

**Grab:** a torch with fresh batteries in the Magic Box; the black cloth from yesterday; a darkened corner or a big cardboard box on its side.

### 2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

Box chant. Shake — *something rolls*. Their eyes go wide.

**EVERYONE** "What's in the box? What's in the box?"

Peek in. Turn the torch on **inside** the box so the lid glows. Gasp at your own box.

**TEACHER** "Yesterday — nothing. Dark! But today..." (*lift out the glowing torch, shine it on the ceiling*)  
"LIGHT!"

"**Light!**" Everyone opens their hands like a flash.

### 4 MIN TEACH · DARK → LIGHT

Lights off. Torch off. Whisper:

Dark... dark... dark... (*hands over eyes, everyone whispers with you*)

Then — **LIGHT!** (*torch ON, straight up at the ceiling*)

I can see! (*hands off eyes, look all around*)

Now shine the torch on things and name them: "**I see a chair!**" Bigs use the full frame "**I see a \_\_\_\_.**"; Littles just shout the thing: "**Chair!**" Shine on a child — the whole class shouts that child's name. Do every child if you can; it takes ten seconds each.

**Teacher fails:** *shine the torch on the door and say "I see a... banana!" Look pleased with yourself. Wait for the roar.*

### 3 MIN SONG · THE BIG BANG BOOM — CHORUS + TUESDAY VERSE

**Chorus** twice with the actions — then yesterday's verse if they shout for it — then today's new one:

**Tuesday's verse:** Then came the light — bright, bright, bright! (*torch on, sweep it over their heads*)

I can see! I can see! What a lovely light! (*point at your eyes, then hands wide*)

*Sing the verse once with the torch **off** and once with it **on**. Same words, completely different feeling — that contrast is the lesson.*

### 3 MIN GAME · TORCH HUNT

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" Room dim. You hold the torch and swing the beam around the circle.

**TEACHER** "The light is looking... for... a SHOE!" (*land the beam on someone's shoe*)

"**Shoe!**" Bigs: "**I see a shoe.**"

Eight rounds: shoe, window, door, whale poster, teacher's nose, a red thing, a small thing, something we love. Then hand the torch to one child at a time — they choose, the class names it. Two turns each, ten seconds a turn.

*Littles who won't speak will still **point** at the beam. Point counts. Say the word for them and move on quickly.*

### 1 MIN CLOSE

Hands over eyes, then fling them open on the shout. Whisper → normal → shout:

**EVERYONE** "Dark... dark... then LIGHT!" (*torch snaps on straight up on the last word*)

**Got 3 spare minutes?** *The Very Lonely Firefly (Eric Carle) — every page is a light. Point and say "Light!" together on each one.*

## WEDNESDAY

# Big, Bigger, BANG!

Today's words: **big** • **bang**

**Grab:** a balloon (plus three spares) in the Magic Box; a pin hidden in your pocket; a tiny bead or dried pea in a matchbox for the “small” contrast.

### 2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

Box chant. Shake — a papery flutter. Peek and pull out... one flat, sad, uninflated balloon.

**TEACHER** “Oh. It's so little. So SMALL.” (*hold it on one fingertip, look disappointed*) “Everything was small like this. Tiny. Smaller than a bean.”

Show the bead in the matchbox. Everyone squints at it. **“Small!”**

**TEACHER** “But watch what happened...” (*one big breath into the balloon*)

### 4 MIN TEACH • BIG → BIGGER → BANG!

Blow the balloon in stages. The class calls each stage with their arms:

**Small!** (*hands together in front of the chest*)

**Big!** (*arms make a beach-ball circle*)

**Bigger!** (*arms wide as they go*)

**BIGGER!** (*stand up, arms up, on tiptoes*)

**BANG!** (*pop it — everyone claps and JUMPS*)

Now they are the balloon: crouch tiny in a ball, grow with your breath, and on your countdown **“three... two... one...”** they explode upwards with a giant **“BANG!”** Three times. Littles just clap and jump on **BANG**; Bigs say **“The universe is very big!”** as they stretch.

**Teacher fails:** blow the balloon up and then say “Look — it's SMALL!” with your arms stretched as wide as they'll go. Hold the pose. Wait.

*Pop-shy child?* Let it go squealing across the room instead of popping — same laugh, no fright — and keep the word **BANG** on the release.

### 3 MIN SONG • THE BIG BANG BOOM — CHORUS + WEDNESDAY VERSE

**Chorus** twice — today make the BANG the loudest thing in the building — then:

**Wednesday's verse:** Big! Big! Bigger! Then... BANG! (*grow from a crouch, explode up*)

Everything went bang-bang-BANG! (*three claps, jump on the last*)

*Today's is the verse they will still be singing in the corridor at home time. Let them shout it.*

### 3 MIN GAME • BALLOON COUNTDOWN

“One, two, three — eyes on me!” Everyone is a tiny ball on the floor.

**TEACHER** “Small... small... growing... big... BIGGER...” (*rise with them, arms opening*)

**EVERYONE** “Three! Two! One! BAAANG!” (*everyone bursts up and out, then flops down giggling*)

Four rounds. Round two you grow very slowly. Round three you fake the bang — stop at “one...” and wait — the class will bang without you. Round four a Big does the counting.

*Land every round with everyone flat on the floor. Big → BANG → flop is the whole shape of a Wednesday.*

### 1 MIN CLOSE

Crouched small, growing on each line, whisper → normal → shout:

**EVERYONE** “Big... bigger... BANG!” (*one enormous clap and jump*)

**Got 3 spare minutes?** *Baby Loves Quarks!* (Ruth Spiro) — don't read the science, just point at each picture: “Small? Or BIG?”

## THURSDAY

# Look at the Stars

Today's words: **star** (*dark · light · big · bang all come back*)

**Grab:** a handful of glow-in-the-dark stars in the Magic Box (charge them under a lamp first!); the torch; blu-tack; the darkest corner of the room.

### 2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

Box chant, whispered. Lights off **before** you open it.

**EVERYONE** "What's in the box? What's in the box?"

Lift the lid slowly. The stars glow up out of the box onto your face.

**TEACHER** "Ohhhh... after the BANG... came the STARS." (*hold one up high and turn slowly so everyone sees it*)

Twinkle fingers all round the circle. **"Star!"**

### 4 MIN TEACH · STARS, AND HOW MANY

Lights stay off. Give every child one glowing star to hold in two hands.

One **star**... (*hold it up*)

Two stars... (*a friend lifts theirs too*)

Three, four, five... (*round the circle, one at a time*)

Too many to count! (*everybody's stars up at once — twinkle them*)

Littles hold up their star and say **"Star!"**; Bigs say **"I see a star."** and then the big one — **"The universe is very big."**

Now everyone blu-tacks their star onto the wall or ceiling in the dark corner. That patch is the class's **universe** and it stays up all week.

**Teacher fails:** *hold up a star and say, delighted, "Look — a SHOE!" Nod. Insist. Let them shout you down twice before you agree.*

### 3 MIN SONG · THE BIG BANG BOOM — CHORUS + THURSDAY VERSE

**Chorus** twice, sung in the dark under the new star wall — then:

**Thursday's verse:** Little stars, little stars, twinkling up high, (*twinkle fingers above the head*)

Millions of stars in the great big sky! (*arms sweep a huge circle overhead*)

*Sing this one slowly. Four fast days need one soft song — they will hush completely and it is the best minute of the week.*

### 3 MIN GAME · STAR FREEZE

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" Music or you strumming: everyone dances/floats around the carpet.

**TEACHER** "FREEZE — be a star!" (*stop playing*)

Everyone freezes in a five-point star shape — legs apart, arms out, fingers spread — and twinkles their fingers without moving anything else. **"Star!"**

Five rounds. Vary the freeze: a **big** star (as wide as you can), a **little** star (curled up small), a **bright** star (torch on them), a **dark** star (hands over eyes). Last round, you freeze wrong on purpose — in a ball — and let them correct your shape.

*Shine the torch on one frozen child at a time and the class shouts "I see a star!" Every child gets one turn to be the star.*

### 1 MIN CLOSE

Under the star wall, hands over eyes, then clap, then twinkle high. Whisper → normal → shout:

**EVERYONE** "Dark... BANG... STARS!" (*hands over eyes · one huge clap · twinkle fingers up high*)

**Got 3 spare minutes?** *How to Catch a Star* (Oliver Jeffers) — stop on every page and ask "Where is the star?" Let a Little come and point.

## FRIDAY

# My Universe Book + Big Review

Today's words: **dark** · **light** · **star** · **big** · **bang** — the whole week

**Grab:** every prop back in the box (black cloth, torch, a fresh balloon, glow stars); black paper and white chalk or a white crayon, one sheet per child; the "My Universe" sheets (print pack page 16) and the awards (page 17); a stapler.

### 2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

The box comes out fat and rattling and glowing at the seams.

**TEACHER** "Today the box is FULL! What is our story?"

Pull the props out one at a time and hold each up in silence — they will supply the word before you can.

Black cloth → "**Dark!**" Torch → "**Light!**" Balloon → "**BANG!**" Glow star → "**Star!**"

### 4 MIN TEACH · THE WHOLE STORY, IN FOUR MOVES

Everyone stands. Tell the First Great Lesson with your bodies, twice — slow, then fast:

It was **dark**... (*curl up small, hands over eyes*)

Everything was **small**... (*smaller, tighter*)

Bigger... bigger... **BANG!** (*grow, then burst up with a clap*)

**Light!** And **stars!** (*hands wide, then twinkle fingers up high*)

And the universe is **BIG**. (*turn all the way round with arms out*)

Littles do the four moves and shout the four words. Bigs tell it back to you in sentences: "**It is dark. Then BANG. I see a star. The universe is very big.**"

**Teacher fails:** start the story with "First there were lots and lots of stars, and then it went dark..." — backwards. They will rebuild the whole week's sequence just to correct you. Let them.

### 3 MIN SONG · THE BIG BANG BOOM — FRIDAY VERSE, THEN THE WHOLE SONG

**Friday's verse:** Dark and light and stars and me — (*hands over eyes · hands wide · twinkle · point at self*)

The universe is BIG as big can be! (*arms as wide as they go, turn all the way round*)

**The finale:** chorus → Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday, Friday → chorus, top to bottom. They learned it one verse a morning without noticing, and this run-through **is** the review of the whole week.

### 3 MIN GAME · PROP QUICK-FIRE

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" Props in a heap in the middle. Hold one up; first hand up names it and does the action for the class to copy.

**TEACHER** "What is it? ... and what do we DO?"

Black cloth → "**Dark!**" (*hands over eyes*)

Torch → "**Light! I see a star.**" (*hands fly open*)

Balloon → "**Big... BANG!**" (*grow and clap*)

Glow star → "**Star!**" (*twinkle fingers*)

Go round twice, faster the second time, then let a Big be the prop-holder. Bigs owe you a sentence; Littles owe you a word and a gesture.

### 1 MIN CLOSE + BOOK FINALE

Hand out the black paper and white chalk: every child draws their own stars, you scribe their line, staple it to their "My Universe" sheet — that is their book, and it goes home today with an award.

Everyone holds their book up. Whisper → normal → shout, with the actions:

**EVERYONE** "Dark... dark... BANG! STARS!" (*hands over eyes · hands over eyes · one huge clap and jump · twinkle fingers up high*)

**Got 3 spare minutes?** *The Everything Seed* (Carole Martignacco) — the same story you just told, in a book. Read only the pictures if time is short.

♪ Today's song moment: chorus → Friday's verse → chorus. One song all week — full words on the last page.

# ★ Theme Song · “The Big Bang Boom”

The one song of the week — sung at every circle. Same chorus daily, one new verse each morning, full song on Friday.

C (0003)

F (2010)

G7 (0212)

**Strum:** Down · Down · Down-Up (“boom — boom — boom-chick”). Can't manage it yet? Four slow downs per bar works fine — the kids only hear the fun.

**Tempo:** start the chorus slow and dark, then drive it — this song accelerates towards the BANG. Stop dead for half a second before “BIG BANG”, then hit the F hard. Chant it without the uke first; add chords once they know the words.

## CHORUS — SING IT EVERY SINGLE DAY

C Dark! Dark! Everywhere F dark! C (hands over eyes)  
F Then — a big, big, C BIG G7 BANG! C (clap and JUMP on BANG)  
C Stars! Stars! Look at the F stars! C (twinkle fingers up high)  
F The universe C goes G7 BANG! C (one huge clap)

Sing the chorus twice each time. On every **BANG** the whole class claps and jumps — that jump is why they remember the word.

## ONE VERSE A DAY — VERSES USE ONLY C AND G7

### Monday · Dark! Nothing At All

C It was dark, dark, dark — no light at all, (hands over eyes, sway)  
G7 No sun, no moon, C no bouncy ball! (shake head three times, bounce a pretend ball)

### Tuesday · Then... Light!

C Then came the light — bright, bright, bright! (torch on, sweep it overhead)  
G7 I can see! I can see! C What a lovely light! (point at your eyes, then hands wide)

### Wednesday · Big, Bigger, BANG!

C Big! Big! Bigger! Then... BANG! (grow from a crouch, explode up)  
G7 Everything went C bang-bang-BANG! (three claps, jump on the last)

### Thursday · Look at the Stars

C Little stars, little stars, twinkling up high, (twinkle fingers above the head)  
G7 Millions of stars C in the great big sky! (arms sweep a huge circle overhead)

### Friday · My Universe Book

C Dark and light and stars and me — (hands over eyes · hands wide · twinkle · point at self)  
G7 The universe is C BIG as big can be! (arms wide, turn all the way round)

**The build:** each day sing chorus → today's verse → chorus. By Friday they know five verses without ever “learning” the song — Friday's finale is the whole thing top to bottom, and it doubles as your review of the entire week.

## IF YOU'RE BRAND NEW TO UKULELE

Practice this loop for five minutes tonight: C (4 strums) → F (4 strums) → C → G7 → C. That's the entire song — the same three shapes as every Whale Class song so far. C is one finger, and the five verses are just C and G7. If your fingers get stuck, put the uke down and clap the chorus instead: the class will not notice, and the BANG lands either way.